In terms of US relations with Saudi Arabia, which has traditionally been considered the United States' most important ally, American involvement in such an initiative, which originated in Saudi Arabia and in which Saudi Arabia is a key partner, would greatly improve relations between the two countries (which have suffered recently because of Saudi Arabia's fundamental distrust of Iran and its reservations about the nuclear agreement signed with it) and will contribute quite a bit to strengthening Saudi Arabia and the Gulf States as a buffer against Iranian expansionism. An American return to the Middle East on the platform of a new regional order and an Israeli-Palestinian agreement would be a huge coup that would restore the status of the United States as the leading superpower, contain radical Islam, curb Russia's re-emergence in the region, and stop the spread of Iranian influence.

Saudi Arabia

As explained above, American involvement in advancing the Saudi peace initiative will undoubtedly improve and strengthen relations between the two countries. It can be assumed that it will also reduce the pressure sometimes felt by the United States to take steps toward democratizing the kingdom, which the Saudi regime is wary of. In this context, American decision makers should consider the following lesson from the Arab Spring revolutions: opposition to authoritarian rule and the attempt to impose democracy soon lead to radical religious dictatorships. In the eyes of Saudi leadership, what the Americans call "democratization" is likely to increase tribal tendencies, to the point of a return to the situation that prevailed during the Ottoman Empire, before the Ibn Saud family succeeded in uniting all of the tribes together under one regime. Tribalism is a threat that hangs over the Saudi regime like the sword of Damocles, so much so that despite the drop in oil prices in recent years from around $140 per barrel to $50 or less a barrel, the regime has not reduced its social welfare allocations even slightly, preferring to deal with a budget deficit than to risk domestic social unrest.

It can also be assumed that such an initiative, in which Saudi Arabia plays a leading role, would be seen by its rulers as a worthy longterm investment that would strengthen their strategic alliance with the United